

"On reaching the spot, however, all they found was a heap of ashes² and, in the sky above them, a cigar-shaped object and two discs.

"One of the discs was hovering at an estimated height of 2,000 feet. It was about 30 ft. in diameter. The engineer took pictures of it, but of the six exposures, only two showed the craft with any degree of clarity.

"The group felt that they had been observed during their visit, for the two discs shot up, merged with the 'cigar', which, after travelling horizontally for a short distance, disappeared into space at a colossal speed."

(This report was also published by *APRO* in their Bulletin.)

Three years later, in the summer of 1958, *FSR* reader Peter Roe of Nottingham was good enough to send me a slightly fuller version of this same report, which gave the name of the man who had had this experience in Argentina with a crashed disc. He was, it seems, Signor Eorice Bessa, aged 44, and Italian architect, formerly a pilot in the Italian Air Force in World War II, who had since become a citizen of Argentina.

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My next selection from the past comes from *FSR* Vol. 2, No. 1 (January/February 1956) where we find, on page six, under the title *Let's Talk Space. Flying Saucers Are Real*, a highly interesting report from a Special Correspondent of *FSR* visiting Mexico.

The first part of the article runs as follows:—

"The United States Authorities have established that flying saucers are manned by visitors from outer space. They are trying to work out a method of breathing and staying alive in our atmosphere before landing and establishing contact.

"This statement was given to a *Flying Saucer Review* special correspondent by a top ranking American V.I.P. — a man whose name would ring millions of bells throughout the world. Here is the report.

"One morning during the summer of 1951, news reporters, news photographers and movie camera men moved into the airport at Mexico City to meet a V.I.P. from the United States. The group was gathered together, and waiting for the visitor, when somebody looked up and gave a shout. Three saucers were hovering over the airport at a height of about 5,000 feet.

"Immediately the cameras went into action, and many photographs, in colour, black and white, stills, and movies, were taken. People poured out of the waiting rooms and restaurant, and several hundred had a fine view of the saucers before they darted off at high speed in a southerly direction. The day following, the newspapers of Mexico City broke the story on their front pages, but there were no pictures. It was reported that the pictures had all been taken by the authorities, and that, after a study had been made by the Mexican

and United States authorities, they would be released for publication. So far³ they have not appeared."

"Later that summer, a highly placed American who was in touch with Air Force Intelligence and in a position to know the facts about flying saucers, admitted to *Flying Saucer Review's* special correspondent, after trying to shrug off the Mexico City Airport incident as 'mob hysteria,' that a camera does not become hysterical, and that dozens, perhaps hundreds, of pictures were taken that day.

"Having got that far, he revealed that it had been established that these were visitors from another planet. That they were completely friendly — their hovering over defence establishments and airports being taken to mean 'We could blow you all to bits at our leisure if we had any evil intent.' That they were undoubtedly trying to work out a method of remaining alive in our atmosphere before landing and establishing friendly communications, and that the United States authorities were completely convinced that Earth had nothing to fear from them. That the U.S. Air Force had been ordered to take no action against their craft.⁴

"Asked why such emphasis had been imposed on denying their existence, and on censoring reports, the V.I.P. official — who would equal a British Cabinet Minister — said that the U.S.A. wanted her people to concentrate on the real menace, Communism; and not to be distracted by the visitors from outer space.

"He went on to say that the Orson Welles broadcast some years ago had demonstrated what reaction might be expected were the true facts generally known: a welter of hysterical nonsense, and a complete disorientation from the tasks in hand. Rumours and speculation would create an atmosphere that the skilled propagandists of the Kremlin would be sure to make the most of.

"Questioned about landings, the official admitted that there had actually been contact with the men in the saucers, and that on three occasions there had been landings which had proved disastrous for the occupants. On each of these occasions breathing the heavily oxygenated atmosphere of this Earth and literally incinerated the visitors from within and had burned them to a crisp.

"At Cuernavaca in Mexico later in the summer of 1951, flying saucers came up in a conversation between our Special Correspondent and a group of Mexican professional men. One of them, an engineer engaged in highway construction, said that he had actually helped to load a flying saucer and its dead crew into an American 'Flying Box-Car' aeroplane. The saucer, according to the engineer, had come down in an uninhabited valley in the Sierra Madre, near where his crew were working.

"'Ah, Señor,' he said, 'they were handsome, those little men, with fine features and beautifully formed tiny hands. But there must have been an explosion in their craft, for they were burnt black, and when I touched the face of one of them the

skin came off under my finger as though it had been cooked!"

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Such, then, was the gist of the special report from FSR's correspondent who went to Mexico in 1955 and secured a personal interview with a top-ranking American V.I.P. regarding the reality of crashed saucers containing small dead beings. But who, you may ask, was this "top-ranking American V.I.P." anyway, and why should one attribute any value whatsoever to such a tale?

The truth as to the identity of the V.I.P. can be revealed, as he is no longer in this world. I contacted FSR's Editor, Derek Dempster, immediately after reading this article in our Journal early in 1956. I asked whether he would kindly tell me, in strict confidence, who the American V.I.P. was?

He replied that it was General George C. Marshall, America's impressive Army Chief of Staff in World War II and, subsequently, the equally brilliant Secretary of State whose name is for ever enshrined in that of the famous Marshall Plan, the unique and unparalleled act of vision and idealism whereby America was able rapidly to see the free nations of Europe on their feet once more, put them firmly on the road to economic recovery.

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My recapitulation of events and reports as given in FSR of almost a quarter of a century ago has been long enough, and I am anxious to keep it down to a manageable length. But there is still one more piece of evidence to which I must refer if this extraordinary business of the early FSR reports of crashed UFOs and little dead men is to be grasped in its proper perspective.

This final piece of evidence is not merely a report, but a whole book, *Behind the Flying Saucers* by Frank Scully, an American journalist. Frank Scully was a veteran newspaperman, and his book, first published in the United States in 1950, is, so far as I am aware, probably only the second or maybe the third of all the many hundreds of books that have now been written on the UFO Phenomenon. Victor Gollancz of London produced a British edition of it in that same year, which sold out very rapidly. Gollancz had difficulty in finding a single copy when they decided they would like to re-issue the book in 1955, and this edition too was soon exhausted.

Scully's story was about an electrifying lecture, which he said had been delivered at 12.30 p.m. on March 8, 1950, before a small audience (350 students) at the University of Denver, Colorado. There was no advance publicity for the talk, which was described simply as "confidential and scientific." It was given during the lunch break, so that the students had to skip lunch to hear it. The lecturer was brought to the auditorium by a Mr. George T. Kohler of Denver, a staff member of a local independent Rocky Mountain radio station with the call

letters KMYR. As to the identity of the lecturer himself, it does not seem that anyone was over-anxious to divulge it at the time, and only after he had gone was it discovered that nobody at the University could say who he was. The local press, when reporting the lecture, simply described him as "an unidentified middle-aged lecturer." Only later, when Scully's book came out in the same year (1950) was it revealed that the lecturer was a famous businessman and personality, Silas M. Newton, a graduate of Yale, a Texan by birth, and one of the great geophysicists of the American oil industry, with a record of successful oil exploration second to none (and a millionaire as a result).

The subject of Newton's astonishing talk to the students was crashed saucers and little dead crews. Newton told his listeners that there had been, up till that date (March 1950), three of these wrecked craft found in the USA, with their dead crews, and that all three machines and the crews had been inspected by scientists with whom he himself was currently associated in geophysical research. He said that the three machines had contained a total of 34 little men measuring between 36 inches and 40 inches in height. The first saucer, said Newton, was found, "less than a year ago," at a place "within 500 miles of Denver."⁵ It was 99.99 feet in diameter and its cabin was 18 feet wide and 6 feet high. The second machine, 72 feet wide, also contained, like the first one, 16 little dead men who, however, had seemingly not suffered from burns like the crew of the first disc, because they had fair complexions. They had no beard, apart from a fine facial down "resembling peach fuzz."

The third disc, said Newton, measured 36 feet in diameter, and contained only two little corpses. The little men had apparently been alive when it landed, but had died as they tried to emerge from the cabin.

Newton gave a vast amount of detail about the craft and the little men — far too much for me to reproduce here. He described the current theories of the American scientists, namely that the discs were operated magnetically, and he also related how American service personnel had succeeded in looting a great many of the smaller instruments and fittings before the authorities could put a stop to this souvenir-gathering. Those who want to see the story in detail must try to get Scully's book and read it. And that may not be easy, for, unless somebody has the sense to republish it, I predict that it will remain a rare and much-sought item. Indeed, in the light of the material already winkled out of the Pentagon by Ground Saucer Watch under the terms of the American Freedom of Information Act, and in the light of the revelations now made by Mr. Leonard H. Stringfield in the article *Retrievals of a Third Kind* which follows this, there may be a mad rush soon to get Scully's book — poorly written though it may be, like so much of the UFO literature.

The Scully book was dynamite, and it naturally created a sensation. It was therefore imperative that Scully be stopped in his tracks, and a feverish and powerful campaign was at once launched to damn and discredit him utterly. That campaign was 100%